Spring 2007

The Coolfont Mountainside Association

Coolfont Mountainside Association

Volume XI Issue III

From the President By Jim Thompson

After April worked so hard to live up to its reputation as being the "cruelest month of all"—at least weather wise, spring is finally coming to the Mountainside. And while in spring a young man's fancy might turn to thoughts of love, the CMA Board is turning to thoughts of well...sewage. Seriously, CMA is at a critical juncture for an important part of our infrastructure. As most of you know, CMA operates its own public water and sewer utilities. Thanks to the largely volunteer efforts of Elmer Broxson, Dwayne Place, Paul Kagen and John Hobday, we have managed to stay "afloat" over the last several years.



Jim, with the Board, discusses "sewage" and other critical concerns.

Our sewage treatment permit with the West Virginia Public Service Commission is due for renewal in May 2009. New Chesapeake Bay watershed pollution standards are being introduced and would eventually require us to upgrade our waste water treatment facilities to reduce levels of nitrogen and phosphorous in our discharge into Sir Johns Run—probably a very expensive proposition. We also face a continuing serious financial risk if either our treatment holding pond or wetlands were to fail.

CMA has been approached by Carl Freeman Companies about joining in with their state-of-the-art sewage treatment plant that will come on line in late 2009. They will turn over the plant and operations to the Warm Spring Public Service District (WSPSD), connecting to their system. This would require running our sewer lines, that

(continued on p.5)

DACC By Flo Bender-Merola

CMA's bylaws state that the DACC (Developmental and Architectural Control Committee) has the primary responsibility of advising and assisting the Board with issues relating to new development and to any physical changes within CMA.

Presently, there are issues that require our attention. Now, more than ever, we must continue to respect the integrity of the Mountainside. Please e-mail Flobender@aol.com if you would like to take part in helping preserve our wonderful community by becoming a member of the DACC.

Gordon Cloney, who stepped down as chair, will continue to act as liaison to the Board. While our "committee name" maybe cumbersome our responsibilities are immense.

Calendar of Events

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May 19

10 am– Board Meeting CMA office

12 N-Pool Clean-Up Day

6:30 pm– Potluck Dinner-R 8

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May 26-28

10 am-5 pm Spring Art Tour

CMA Pool Open

May 27-CMA Pool Party

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June 9

10 am-Board Meeting CMA office

6:30 pm-Potluck Dinner-K 3

June 10

CMA Pool Party and Barbecue

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July 14

10 am-Board Meeting CMA office

6:30 pm-Potluck Dinner (TBA)

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Aug 11

10 am-Board Meeting CMA office

6:30-Potluck Dinner (TBA)

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September 8

Annual Meeting

(Time & Place TBA)

6:30 pm-Annual Dinner-Barn

September 9

CMA Pool Party and Barbecue

Firewise Day 2007 By Richard Kaufman

Firewise Day was held on April 24, 2007 and was a great success. Among those in attendance as invited guests were James Steiner, the new Chief of the Berkeley Springs Volunteer Fire Company, and John Anderson, Fire Forester with the West Virginia Division of Forestry. Also present were Jim Thompson, President of CMA, several members of the CMA Board, and a number of homeowners.

We are required to have such an annual event devoted to a particular project in order to remain officially sanctioned by the State of West Virginia and the national Firewise Communities Program as a Firewise community. We take pride in the fact that CMA was the first such community to be officially recognized in West Virginia.



CMA members and invited guests inspecting a CMA home.

It is interesting to note that the program is spreading throughout the nation among communities such as ours that are susceptible to forest fires because they are located in forested or woodland areas. There are now 211 Firewise communities in 33 states, an increase of nearly 50 percent over the past year.

The purpose of Firewise Day is to keep our members informed about existing conditions and about steps that can be taken to reduce the hazards of a wild fire. For example, among the hazards that can be prevented are leaves and brush around the base of the homes, firewood on decks, and flammable materials such as gas cans located too close to

(continued on page 3)

Out and About in Berkeley Springs By Lois Copeland

For a small town Berkeley Springs can be a very busy place, especially in the spring and summer. We have the option of being *one with nature* or socializing in town or a little of both.

The **2007 Delectable Mountains Quilt Show** is at the Ice House Gallery from April 13 thru May 28. More than 30 quilts made by the members of Delectable Mountain Quilters are on display, some quilts will be for sale, others not.

The Delectable Mountain Quilters do something unique during its showing, a Yard-Square Quilts display and silent auction. Thirty-nine small pieces of quilt hang in businesses through out town. The finale for this month long display and auction is at the Ice House on May 28 at 5 pm. Displaying a quilt has become very popular with businesses throughout town.



Friday May 18 a new night spot opens: **La Luna Gallery and Wine Bar** at 48 N Washington St., above Nature Niche. Their hours on Friday and Saturday night are 5:30 pm-11 pm. This beautifully appointed bar and gallery is a must see and will feature fine wines from all over the world.

(continued on page 4)

New War Memorial Hospital By Lois Copeland

War Memorial Hospital purchased 80.5 acres of land about 1.5 miles from the present hospital to build a new facility.

Initially, War Memorial Hospital, was known as "The Pines", a center for post paralysis care. By 1947 the number of polio cases declined and there was a pressing need for a local hospital. The Pines morphed into War Memorial Hospital.

War Memorial Hospital is licensed by the State of West Virginia as a Critical Access Hospital because of its rural location. This designation limited how far the hospital may be relocated from its present location.

The hospital has forty one beds; twenty five acute care beds and a sixteen bed long term unit. The new facility will be "state of the art", but the bed capacity will remain about the same.



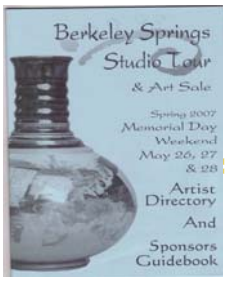
War Memorial Hospital

The hope is for a 2008 ground breaking and 12 to 18 months to complete construction.

Berkeley Springs: All Art Community

Small Art Town Ranking

The Morgan Arts Council marks the start of its 30th year "getting art out there" with its hometown of Berkeley Springs firmly entrenched in the top 10 art destinations in America for small cities and towns. In previous years, Berkeley Springs has been ranked as high as #12 competing against all size locations and now is #6 following such notable art towns as Sante Fe and Asheville rated first and second respectively. The list is compiled by /American Style/ magazine from votes cast by the public. "This is the fifth year Berkeley Springs has been nationally ranked," said Jeanne Mozier, local arts promoter." No other West Virginia town made the list," she said pointing out that Berkeley Springs is also the state's first and only certified arts community."



An example of art in our community

Certified Arts Community

The West Virginia Commission on the Arts voted recently to name Berkeley Springs as the state's first Certified Arts Community. "We consider Berkeley Springs the poster child for an arts community in West Virginia," said Susan Landis, Commission Chair as she accepted the group's vote to certify the Eastern Panhandle town.

Former Commissioner of Culture and History Troy Body established the certification program in mid November 2005. ...A process of documentation is outlined for the nomination. ...The petition recognizes "the value of the arts to life in Berkeley Springs and Morgan County" citing a half-dozen reasons including tourism, economic impact and education enhancement for both children and adults.

Information for both articles obtained from the MAC website: http://macicehouse.org.

Berkeley Springs Studio Tour

The annual Spring Studio Tour will take place in Berkeley Springs during the Memorial Day weekend, May 26, 27, and 28, daily 10 AM—5 PM. There will be an opening reception at the Berkeley Castle on Friday, May 25, 7 PM—9 PM.

Included among the 20 studios in the tour is that of one of our resident artists, Richard Kaufman. Richard's Magic Mountain Studio is located in his home at 579 Bobcat Drive, Lot R3. Richard and his wife, Dilys Parry, invite all CMA members and their guests to stop by during the tour to see his recent paintings.

Richard's work focuses on the rhythms and the energies of nature. In his landscapes and seascapes, and his portraits of wild and domestic life he combines traditional Asian and Western techniques with his own unique perspective.



Painting from Richard Kaufman's collection on Studio Tour (right)

Firewise Day 2007 (con't)

the homes. The goal is to increase the chance that your home will survive in the event that there is a fire in our area.

Towards that end we devoted this year's Firewise Day to inspections of the conditions immediately surrounding the homes in our community. We began by inspecting a home with the assistance of Fire Chief Steiner and John Anderson who advised us about how to use the inspection form provided by the Division of Forestry and how to calculate whether a home should be rated low, moderate, or high with regard to its wildfire hazard. Members of the group then went on with copies of the form to inspect one or two homes each.

Inspection of all the homes on the mountainside will require some more time. A report on our findings will be made to all homeowners.



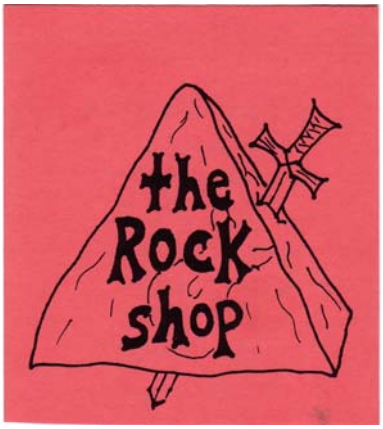
CMA members learning how to use the inspection form.

The Rock Shop Opens

By Lois Copeland

Two new stores opened in Berkeley Springs this season, The Rock Shop and Himalayan Handicrafts. The Rock Shop, located at 240A Wilkes Street near the corner of U.S. Route 9 West and Wilkes Street carries jewelry, gemstones, gifts made by local artists, beads and jewelry-making supplies and books.

Owner-manager Mayo Fredo decided to open a shop to sell her wares as well as jewelry, arts and crafts pieces made by other local artists. Fredo is well known in the area having worked at The Bath House for five years and at The Red Guitar.



Fredo paints yard and garden stones and paints rock art. She paints beautiful rocks depicting nature scenes. The Rock Shop also carries gifts such as shea butter and assorted lotions, creams, bath salts and scrubs.

Fredo's shop carries pet supplies and a percentage of the proceeds from the pet items goes to support The Humane Society, which she is president of. Fredo has a foster program for shelter cats and features an adoption board for pets needing homes.

Mayo Fredo has managed to meld two passions into one shop, showcasing her artistic flair and the love for the well being of animals.

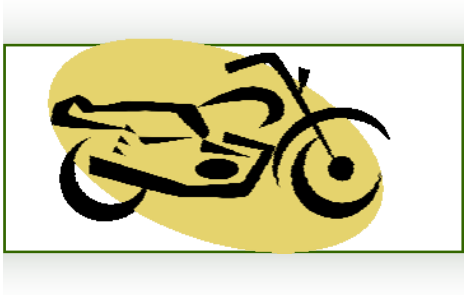
Out and About in Berkeley Springs (con't)

June is Biker Month in Berkeley Springs. The Morgan County Arts Council is sponsoring a **Motorcycle Arts Show** titled **VROOM, VROOM** at the Ice House in during the month of June.

Friday, June 1 from 7:30 pm-9 pm is a gala opening with a special movie **Vroom Vroom,** art and the motorcycle at the Ice House Gallery. The exhibit will feature wood carving, paintings, stained glass and ceramics and motorcycles.

Biker Month will also include guided rides and two biker parades through town, Saturday, June 2 at 5 pm and Saturday, June 23. Following the biker parade June 23 there will be music in Berkeley Springs Park and bike admiring.

The weekly **Summer Concerts In the Park** series starts Saturday, June 2 at Berkeley Springs State Park, admission free. These concerts feature ethnically and culturally diverse music ranging from traditional Appalachian and blues to Caribbean, Central European and world beat.



And don't forget our Farmer's Market. It gets bigger and bigger as the season goes on!

See you on the streets or the trails.

Lets's Go Hiking!!

By Carroll Yingling

Two hiking trails are available to CMA hikers, both are on CMA (and State Park) property. Both would be considered Level Two Walks...2-5 miles, over well defined trails, with ascents/descents 500+, and some loose rocks during a steep ascent (White Trail).

The White Trail is accessible from either Dogwood, Wintergreen or Bobcat Drive. The White Trail intersects with the Blue-Orange Trail leading to Prospect Rock (overlooking Great Cacapon); and the Blue-Red Trail leading to the Rock Slab Vista (overlooking CMA). The Blue Trail provides a less strenuous hike, leading to the same two destinations. It is accessible from Bobcat Drive, about 50 feet from the intersection of Bobcat and Mountainside Road. (see graphic)



Hiking trails for all to enjoy!

Walking shoes or boots are appropriate. Carry water, snacks and raingear/poncho if there is a weather threat. Plan on 2-5 hours to enjoy either of these walks.

From the President (con't)

currently empty into the holding pond, under St. Johns Run to hook up with Freeman lines on the east side. We are conducting engineering assessments of what is required and cost estimates.

The down side of joining the WSPSD system are the upfront costs to hook up to their system and potentially higher sewer rates than our current rates—which are nearly the lowest in the state. We will investigate a bulk fee structure for CMA. The upside is that we would not have future significant expenses to upgrade waste water treatment facilities to meet Chesapeake Bay standards or repair our holding pond and wetlands. In fact, Freeman has offered to restore the holding pond and wetlands areas, if CMA agrees not to develop that area. As a community, we will still be responsible for our septic tanks and the lines that take our discharge to the Freeman lines.

We must notify Freeman by June 1st whether we intend to join with them so they can finalize their engineering plans. Therefore, we will use the scheduled May 19th Board Meeting to review and decide CMA's course of action. This will NOT affect the CMA water system. We will separately be developing a long term plan for our water operations.

On a lighter note, we held our 2007 Firewise Day on April 14th—thanks to those who participated. We will be updating the 2003 assessments of the Firewise risk associated with CMA homes over the next few months. We plan to submit our request for 2007 national Firewise recognition in the next few months. If you have done any Firewise projects around your home this year, please report your volunteer hours to Richard Kaufman.

In addition to the monthly Board meetings and Potluck Dinners, the CMA summer schedule includes a Pool Beautification Day on May 19th, pool parties on May 27th, June 10th and September 9th and the CMA Annual Meeting and Dinner on September 8th. Please put these events on your calendar and plan to join us!

Rosemary Lardner Dies, Longtime CMA Resident

By George Lardner

Rosemary Lardner, who loved and lived in L-4 on Wintergreen Way, died February 22, 2007 in Hagerstown from a massive stroke she suffered while shopping there two days earlier.

She was an artist and framing specialist and did much of her work at the Coolfont home, especially in the past year . She painted landscapes, still lifes and portraits. For framing work, another love, she had huge machines in the back bedroom of her home in Washington, D.C. that cut glass and mats with great precision. At Coolfont, she made quilts, pillows, wall hangings and the beginnings of a huge bedspread. Rosemary loved walking in the woods. And she loved animals, wild or tame. She fed them all. She left birdseed everywhere and was almost, though not quite, as happy when squirrels got them. Her Irish wolfhounds, who died one by one at an early age, worshipped her. So did Theda, her "West Virginia mutt," as she called her when we got her from the Humane Society of Morgan County where Rosemary stopped frequently with snacks and food. But Theda usually stayed in D.C. and for company at Coolfont, where she was recovering from a broken hip, she took care of her cat, Cato.



On the day of her stroke, after a weekend in D.C., she kept saying she had to get back to Coolfont because "Cato misses me." He never saw her again and he misses her very much. So do her husband, George, and three surviving children. Rosemary was 72 and was buried next to her youngest daughter, Kristin, who was killed in 1992.

Saying Farewell

By Hallie Kerr

Our mountainside community lost a special neighbor this winter—Rosemary Lardner.

Rosemary came here less often of late, due to health issues. But we used to see her on the road, walking her beautiful dogs, to whom she was devoted.

I didn't know Rosemary well; we shared rides down to the spa pool and some telephone conversations about how naughty our dogs had been on any given day. She always stopped by the Humane Society's booth at the *Apple Butter Festival* to inquire about our well being. But, if you can know some one by their actions, then I felt that I knew Rosemary.

Rosemary had a great fondness and concern for the animals at our Morgan County Humane Society and for the people who worked to give them a future. She was a person with deep convictions and demonstrated that by her support and donations



She supported animals and their wel-

lovingly supported to the Humane Society.

Rosemary touched my life and I will miss her. Her passing is a loss to the mountainside and to the Humane Society Shelter which she

Coolfont Mountainside Association

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We sadly say goodbye to Kevin Spitler and Carla Anderson and their son. They are relocating to Wisconsin. We wish them all the best.

We want to thank Jackson Bain who designed our CMA logo. We felt naked without a logo to identify us.

We want to thank Bob Borchers for maintaining our old website. And now for our new and improved mountainside website. Visit it frequently and find what's happening on the mountainside and in town.



Meet Our New Logo



The Technology Corner

By Ron Wohl

DSL from Verizon is now fully accessible to all Verizon telephone customers in CMA. Attaching your computer to the DSL service is very simple and is done through a modem/router device that will be mailed to you, once you order the DSL service. When you order your service, tell the agent whether you want to have "wireless service" or "direct wire " service. Verizon will send you the router/modem you need to attach your computer (s) to the service, along with easy to understand instructions and a CD to direct your installation. In addition, to the modem/router, they will also send you filters (with easy to understand instructions on how to use them) to protect your DSL service from any interference from other equipment that may use a phone line such as a fax machine, directly wired telephone or an answering machine.

The power available is 768 megabytes per second or 3 megabytes for a residence. A business service is available at a higher monthly fee; however it gives only 3 mbs, but can have a static internet address applied. (For most needs, the business service is not any better than the 3 mbs residential service at half the cost!) Contact your Verizon telephone office (see the back of the first page of your monthly bill for the telephone number). By ordering DSL, you will also receive an additional discount on your Verizon monthly telephone bill.

Now that we have gotten DSL service extended to CMA, we are working to get Comcast or Verizon to bring cable to CMA.



Communicating with the world in the 21st century from the mountainside!

What other technology desires, questions or ideas do you have? Please drop us an e-mail and let us know your suggestions. We are always willing to look into new issues and get you answers on your questions.

**** A new feature for our newsletter! <u>The Technology Corner</u> here on page six with every edition. Send inquires to Jackson Bain, Bob Borchers, or Ron Wohl.***